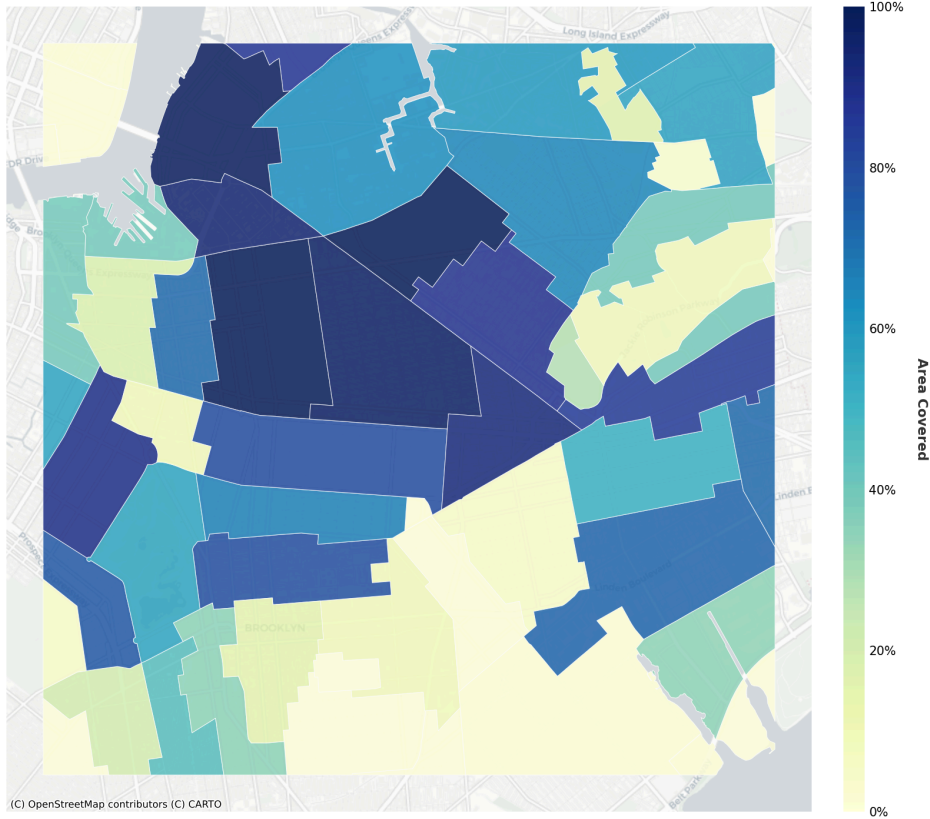


## Comparing NYC and Paris Soccer Pitch Accessibility

### Soccer Pitch Accessibility in NYC

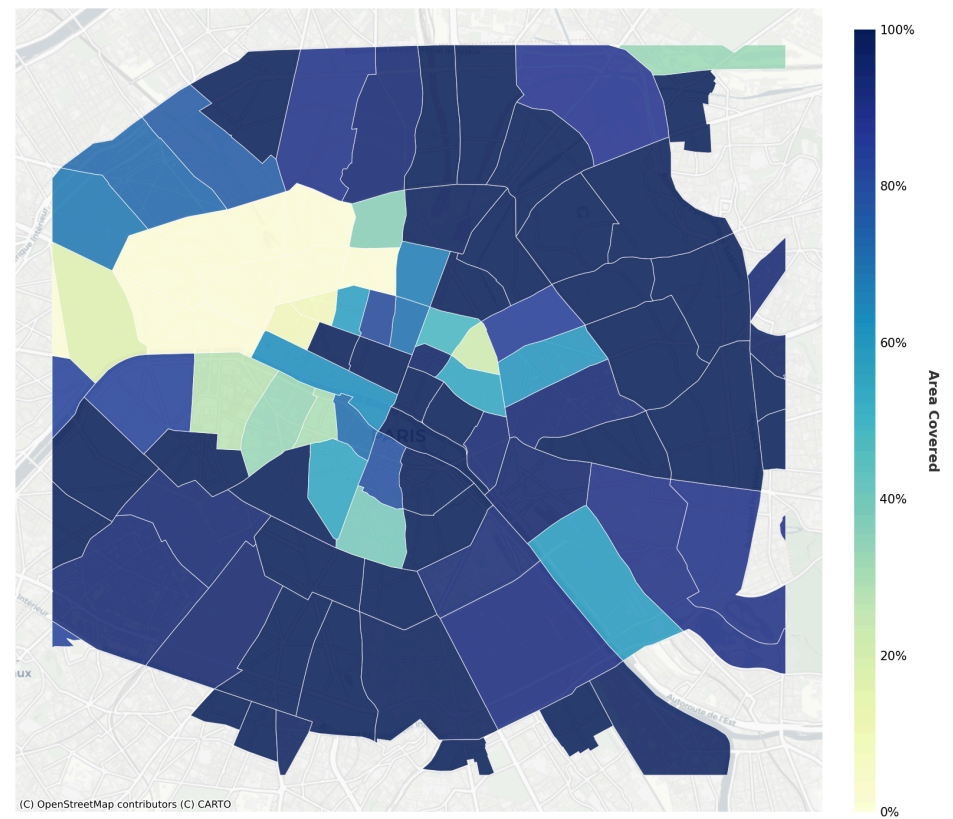
% of area within a 15-minute walk, by neighborhood



(C) OpenStreetMap contributors (C) CARTO  
Data Sources: OpenStreetMap, NYC Dept. of City Planning

### Soccer Pitch Accessibility in Paris

% of area within a 15-minute walk, by quartiers



(C) OpenStreetMap contributors (C) CARTO  
Data Sources: OpenStreetMap

**Analysis:** While acknowledging the vast differences in overall urban footprint and population density, a spatial analysis of the 15-minute walkability to soccer pitches reveals a stark contrast in urban recreational equity between the centers of Paris and New York City (within a 10km square). In Paris, mapping by quartiers demonstrates systemic, continuous coverage across the urban core, successfully reflecting a "15-minute city" planning that lowers the barrier to entry for spontaneous play. Conversely, NYC's neighborhood tabulation areas expose a highly fragmented "zip-code lottery", where dense clusters of accessibility sit directly adjacent to severe infrastructure deserts, forcing many residents to rely on transit or planned leagues for basic recreational access.

**Methodology:** This analysis quantified pedestrian accessibility by calculating 15-minute walking catchment areas around soccer pitches in both cities. Using Python libraries including GeoPandas and OSMnx, pedestrian street networks and recreational points of interest were extracted from OpenStreetMap. To model realistic pedestrian movement, I utilized network-routing algorithms to generate precise 15-minute walking isochrones along the physical street grid, rather than simple Euclidean buffers. These individual catchments were then dissolved into a unified coverage mask. To ensure mathematically precise area calculations, all geographic data was projected into local metric coordinate reference systems (EPSG:2263 for NYC and EPSG:2154 for Paris). Finally, the coverage mask was spatially intersected with local administrative boundaries (official Neighborhood Tabulation Areas in NYC and mapped Quartiers in Paris) to determine the exact percentage of each district's total land area that falls within a 15-minute walk of a pitch.